

from Digital Garage in subjects such as software development, ML, Google Cloud, data, python and more. The platform also has curated paid courses from EdX, Coursera and others.

Simplilearn

One of the most prominent providers of online certifications, Simplilearn offers online courses in disciplines such as cybersecurity, cloud computing, project management, digital marketing, data science, and more. It helps early to mid-career professionals acquire new-age digital skills. The startup claims to have already helped over 3 million professionals and companies upskill and acquire certifications.

Other platforms for upskilling and reskilling in India include SkillShare, Udemy, UdaCity, LinkedIn Learning, Corporate Gurukul, and more.

SIDE GIGS

If you've been experiencing job uncertainty, taking up a side job or gig in your spare time could provide you with some much-needed peace of mind due to the added income source. Remember, however that in some cases this violates your agreement with your company, so read the fine print of the agreement you signed before starting a side gig. You don't want your side gig to be the reason you get fired in a recession!

Freelance writing

Freelance writing is a perfect side hustle for topic experts, CV writers, and copywriters. You can leverage your geek skills to provide invigorating content to publications, websites or companies that have needs that align with your interests. However, it is a job that requires tons of initiative from your end. You need to stay on top of following leads, interacting with potential clients, and scour social media and job posting sites.

Places to look: iWriter, Contena, Fiverr, Blogging Pro, Freelancer.com

Selling photographs

If photography is your passion, and

A FEW UPSKILLING COURSES TO BOOST YOUR CAREER

- Data Scientist Master's Program: Simplilearn
- Artificial Intelligence Course: Simplilearn
- Executive post-graduate program in Healthcare Management: UpGrad
- Digital Marketing Master's course: Coursera
- PG Diploma in Software Development: UpGrad

you're good at it, you can monetise your talent. First, it is important to define your niche; be it food, fashion, nature, travel, or event photography. Build up an impressive enough portfolio, and while this may mean working for free in the beginning, it will be worth it in time. You could

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“No matter where you are on your career journey – employed, unemployed, furloughed or a new graduate – upskilling is a great way to stay relevant in the workforce. By adding new proficiencies or bolstering existing skills, you add value to your marketability and make your skillset more recession-proof.”

–Lauren Frazer, Senior Editor
for Indeed's Career Guide

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then begin selling your work to stock photography websites and license them online. You could also take up a few in-person gigs that will possibly pay more.

Places to sell: Fiverr, iStock, Freepik, Canva, Adobe Stock

Part-time tutoring

If you're willing to impart your expertise in a particular field, there will be a considerable number

of people willing to pay to learn from you. Thanks to the pandemic, you can do this from the comfort of your home as people are used to learning online.

Places to tutor: Vedantu, TutorVista, Tutor.com, TutorME, MathElf

Online reselling

Online reselling is not just a side hustle, some people even get their entire income solely from this practice. It is the practice of acquiring stuff at a discounted or wholesale price and then selling it for a markup. Thanks for social media, you don't even need to have a physical location to get into this business. It is a good idea to pick a niche or segment of products you want to dabble in, narrow down your target audience and conduct competition analysis; as basic as it may be. This gives you a good idea of what prices to set. You can source items for reselling from friends and family, your own personal collection, auctions, flea markets, thrift stores, clearance sales, and more.

Places to sell: Meesbo, OLX, eBay, Quikr, Amazon Seller Marketplace

Survey taking

Several companies value consumer opinions and pay for them pretty handsomely. There are many websites out there that will pay you for sharing your opinions on products and services. This is one of the easiest side hustles, and can be done in your free time from the comfort of your home. You need to spot frauds though, so stick to reputed sites only.

Places to look: Viewfruits, Toluna, Shifrin Hayworth, Schlesinger Group's Focus Group

There are several avenues to make money from a side hustle or gig and due to space constraints, we can't cover all of them in detail. However, some other promising options include blogging, starting a YouTube channel, Airbnb hosting, becoming an online consultant, becoming a social media influencer, renting out unused furniture, and babysitting/petsitting. 